3: Ethics Policy

3.A. Core Items

WALLE-AI's ethics policy is grounded in the principle that technology should enhance human well-being without compromising rights, dignity, or fairness. The first core item is **Respect for Human Autonomy**. WALLE-AI systems are designed to support decision-making, not replace it. Users must always retain control over their choices, and AI recommendations should be clearly presented as suggestions rather than directives. This includes limiting persuasive design techniques that could manipulate user behavior or create dependency.

The second core item is **Privacy and Data Protection**. Because WALLE-AI systems collect sensitive behavioral and personal data, strict data minimization practices are enforced. Only necessary data is collected, all data is encrypted both in transit and at rest, and users must provide informed, explicit consent before any data collection begins. Additionally, users have the right to access, correct, or delete their data at any time. Data sharing with third parties, such as healthcare providers or family members, is strictly opt-in and transparent.

The third core item is **Fairness and Non-Discrimination**. WALLE-AI is committed to ensuring that its AI systems perform equitably across different populations, including varying ages, disabilities, income levels, and cultural backgrounds. This goes beyond statistical fairness by addressing broader issues of justice, such as access and outcomes. Regular bias audits are conducted, and any performance disparities must remain within strict thresholds. When disparities are identified, corrective measures are required before further deployment.

The fourth core item is **Transparency and Explainability**. Users and stakeholders must be able to understand how WALLE-AI systems operate. This includes clear explanations of how recommendations are generated, what limitations exist, and when AI is being used instead of a human. Transparency also applies at the organizational level, with public reporting on system performance, ethical audits, and known limitations.

The fifth core item is **Accountability and Oversight**. WALLE-AI establishes clear lines of responsibility for all AI-driven outcomes. Internal teams are accountable for monitoring system performance, while independent audits and an ethics board provide external oversight. Mechanisms are in place for users to report concerns, file complaints, and receive timely resolutions. This ensures that the company remains responsible for both intended and unintended consequences of its technology.

The sixth core item is **Accessibility and Equity**. WALLE-AI recognizes that ethical technology must be accessible to all, not just those with financial or technological advantages. The company implements income-based pricing, partnerships for subsidized access, and training programs to

ensure usability across diverse populations. This addresses systemic inequalities and works toward equitable distribution of benefits.

The seventh core item is **Human-Centered Labor Consideration**. WALLE-AI acknowledges the labor involved in developing and maintaining AI systems, including data labeling, system monitoring, and caregiving roles that may be affected by automation. The company is committed to fair labor practices, transparent acknowledgment of human contributions, and retraining opportunities for workers whose roles may be impacted.

The eighth core item is **Interdisciplinary Collaboration and Social Responsibility**. WALLE-AI integrates insights from fields such as healthcare, sociology, ethics, and law to ensure well-rounded decision-making. The company actively collaborates with community organizations, researchers, and policymakers to align its technology with societal needs and values.

3.B. Board

One member of the WALLE-AI ethics board would be **Dr. Timnit Gebru**, a renowned computer scientist and leading voice in ethical AI. She is the founder of the Distributed AI Research Institute (DAIR) and previously co-led Google's Ethical AI team. Her work focuses on algorithmic bias, data ethics, and the societal impacts of AI systems, particularly on marginalized communities. She has published influential research on facial recognition bias and the risks of large-scale AI models. Dr. Gebru is an ideal choice because her expertise directly aligns with WALLE-AI's need to ensure fairness and prevent discrimination in assistive technologies that serve vulnerable populations.

Another board member would be **Dr. Joy Buolamwini**, a researcher at MIT and founder of the Algorithmic Justice League. Her work centers on identifying and addressing bias in AI systems, particularly those affecting race and gender. She is widely known for her research exposing bias in facial recognition technologies and for advocating greater accountability in AI development. Dr. Buolamwini brings a strong ethical perspective grounded in both technical expertise and social justice, making her well-suited to guide WALLE-AI in building inclusive and equitable systems.

The third member would be **Satya Nadella**, CEO of Microsoft, who has extensive experience leading a major technology company with a strong emphasis on responsible AI. Under his leadership, Microsoft has implemented AI ethics principles focused on fairness, reliability, privacy, and inclusiveness. Nadella's background combines technical knowledge with large-scale organizational leadership, providing valuable insight into how ethical policies can be implemented in practice. He was chosen because he offers a balance between ethical vision and real-world execution, helping ensure that WALLE-AI's ethical commitments are scalable and sustainable.

Together, these board members provide a combination of deep ethical expertise, technical knowledge, and leadership experience, ensuring that WALLE-AI's ethics policy is both principled and actionable.